

Benchmark: Jardins de Cocagne

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Date: 07/09/2026

I. Growing home (<https://www.growinghomeinc.org/>)

Growing Home is an association based in Chicago, United States of America (USA) that operates in high-production farms to train individuals who are eager to work but need a supportive environment to develop their strengths as employees. The Production Assistants, who are admitted after a vigorous recruitment process to assess their suitability and motivation, are involved in every aspect of farm production, including planting, harvesting, washing, weighing, packaging and selling our produce to customers across Chicago. Production Assistants work in teams alongside staff, graduates, and volunteers to reach social enterprise sales goals as well as their mission to improve access to healthy food to underserved neighbourhoods.

1.1 Analyse

The Growing Home website has a relatively good, structured architecture, with a clear navigation system separating the organisation's information, programmes, impact, farms and opportunities for participation. From a UI perspective, the website uses a conventional section-based layout, with large content blocks, images, call-to-action buttons and text section although some pages have a high-density content that affects the visual hierarchy and reading efficiency.

Furthermore, there is limited use of interactive UI components such as animated transitions, interactive maps, filtering systems or dynamic data visualisations. Implementing these features could improve user engagement while also providing more effective ways of presenting information such as the organisation's social and environmental impact. The elevated number of media and multimedia which in big quantity can negatively affect loading times therefore they should use modern formats and responsive sizing, while lazy loading could be applied to media that is not immediately visible. Accessibility could also be strengthened through appropriate semantic HTML, alternative text for images, sufficient colour contrast, keyboard navigation and clearly identifiable interactive elements.

Overall, the Growing Home website provides a functional structure and communicates its objectives effectively, but its technical design could be improved through a stronger component system, better responsive optimisation, more interactive elements and greater attention to performance and accessibility.

Advantages	Disadvantages
Clear and structured navigation architecture.	Some pages have a high content density.
Consistent use of content sections and CTA elements.	Visual hierarchy could be stronger.
Responsive structure suitable for different types of content.	Some layouts could be better optimised for small screens.
Uses images and multimedia to complement textual content.	Limited interactive UI components.
Clear separation between programmes, impact and participation.	Limited use of interactive data visualisation or maps.
Strong potential for reusable UI components.	Performance could be affected by large media assets if they are not optimised.
Clear calls-to-action for user engagement.	Accessibility could be improved through stronger semantic and interaction practices.

II. Cultivate London (<https://cultivatelondon.org>)

Cultivate London is an independent social enterprise and charity. They work in improving employment, education, health and wellbeing outcomes of the communities in London by improving the natural environment, setting a standard for engaging communities in their green spaces and providing greater access and understanding of community and environmental needs.

Their unique approach is the bespoke and tailored horticultural services, support and opportunities provided by their registered horticulturists and educational professionals.

2.1 Analyse

The Cultivate London website presents a clear functional structure, with the homepage immediately introducing the organization, its social purpose, and its main areas of activity and this categorization makes the information architecture relatively clear, allowing users to quickly identify the different aspects of the organization.

In terms of layout and UI, the site follows a traditional content-based structure, combining promotional banners, introductory text, service categories, testimonials, and recent posts, which generates a logical flow of information. However, the visual hierarchy could be stronger: several sections rely mainly on text and simple titles, without a sufficiently clear distinction between primary and secondary information, service categories, for example, would benefit from more visually distinct cards or icons to facilitate quick reading.

The website also makes good use of internal navigation, with pages dedicated to different activities and projects, and the footer provides important institutional resources such as annual reports, GDPR documentation, job openings, and the organization's theory of change—which is technically useful as it provides access to both public content and more formal documentation. However, the visual and interactive layer of the site is relatively limited: the homepage is mainly composed of static content, links, and images, with little evidence of advanced interactive components. For an organization focused on urban horticulture and community engagement, features such as an interactive map of community gardens, project filtering, animated impact statistics, or image galleries would make the presentation of activities more engaging.

From a responsiveness and accessibility standpoint, it would also be important to optimize typography, spacing, navigation, and content density for smaller screens, progressively reorganizing information instead of simply stacking it vertically, and ensuring sufficiently large touch targets and clear visual states in interactive elements.

In short, the Cultivate London website has a solid information architecture and good functional coverage, but its UI could be considerably modernized.

Advantages	Disadvantages
Clear categorisation of the organisation's main activities.	Relatively dated visual design and interface.
Good internal navigation, with dedicated pages for each activity/project	Deep dropdown submenus may be harder to manage on smaller screens
Good internal navigation between services and projects.	Several sections rely heavily on text and simple headings, with insufficient distinction between primary and secondary information

Service categories are well defined and cover the organisation's full range of activities	Service cards could be more visually distinctive
Footer provides access to important resources such as GDPR documentation and annual reports.	Lack of a reusable component system;
Testimonials provide social proof and credibility.	Content is mostly static missing features such as an interactive map of community gardens, project filtering, animated impact statistics, or image galleries
	Mobile layout and content density could be further optimised.

III. Sutton Community Farm (<https://www.suttoncommunityfarm.org.uk/>)

Sutton Community Farm is an organically-farmed land governed by a collective of members, undertaking its operation as a support for the community under the "not-for-profit" category. Besides producing food, it has a strong focus on volunteers and community health as it has more than 70 volunteers each week. Its main occupation is to offer seasonal organic veg box subscription services at the doorstep of clients engaged in producing staple food like bread and eggs. The website is designed as both an e-store and community center.

3.1 Analyse

The site design has an up-to-date feel with a focus on making sales. The homepage has a clear offering of vegetable boxes. The contents of the page are the price of the boxes, an easy basket icon for purchases, and even a whole community aspect. The site provides a link for community events; the section about volunteering and community lunch is easy to spot; sections on recipes and news are updated frequently on the site. The only downside of the design is the homepage being too long and full of images, giving it a cluttered feel.

Advantages	Disadvantages
Efficient e-commerce system: navigation by categories, price for each product, one-click	The homepage is quite lengthy as there are many blocks of texts (especially news

option to add product to cart.	articles) placed in various places on the homepage.
Newest technical features: system of accounts/sign-ins, consent banner for cookies, form for subscribing to the newsletter.	The use of large images for the products may slow down the speed of loading.
Mobile-friendly design that can be used on different devices.	The repetition of the same block does not provide an efficient and simple way for navigating through the homepage.
Clear structure of the menu where shop categories are separated from information pages.	There is no search bar visible that allows the user to quickly and conveniently find any product or page.

IV. Growing Gardens (<https://growinggardens.org/>)

In Boulder County, Colorado, the non-profit organization Growing Gardens is working with the slogan of "cultivating community through regenerative urban agriculture." For over 25 years, this organization has combined food donations with teaching and has been engaged in community gardens, CSA programs, programs for kids and teenagers, goat farm, and horticultural therapy services. Due to this, this non-profit said that it has reached out to more than 136,000 people. The type of the website provides the main information as well as information about events or donation opportunities.

4.1 Analyse

The website features a comprehensive multi-layer dropdown menu with the first-level headings (About Us, What We Do, Get Involved, Ways to Give, Contact), each of them highlighting several sub-pages (up to 6-8 sub-pages under each category title). On the one hand, this organizational scheme allows having many types of information published on the website; on the other hand, deep structure of the website means a visitor needs to look through a sub-menu in order to find all types of program that are not available on the home page. The home page consists of a series of full-width banners about relevant events (farm events, festivals) followed by mission statements and a series of animated counters (the number of people helped and the amount of products donated). There is also a small block stating “Get Involved” made as a tile

with images redirecting to key pages and the logos of the sponsors at the bottom of the home page which is also a typical solution for the credibility issue on many non-profit websites. Functionally, the website works and has a search bar, an entrance to the “personal account”, and a small online shop for goat dairy.

Advantages	Disadvantages
The architecture of the site is rich in content and provides multi-level menu aspect for a wide range of programs.	The presence of deep menus implies that numerous clicks will be needed to access content from the homepage.
The site has functional elements such as search bar, authorisation area and integrated shop.	There is a lack of a single, easily visible call-to-action such as a 'donate' or a 'join' button in the centre of the homepage.
The statistics section introduces a dynamic element of statistics and information.	Animated counters are likely built on JavaScript platform, which can influence the website's accessibility.
The approach used to structure the page is consistent (use of the same banners, tiles and the area featuring donors).	The homepage contains a higher degree of promotional banners in comparison to clear and well-structured hierarchy of information.

V. Summary

Website	Advantages	Disadvantages
	- Clear and structured navigation architecture. - Consistent use of content sections and CTA elements. - Responsive structure suitable for different types of content. - Uses images and multimedia to complement	- Some pages have a high content density. - Visual hierarchy could be stronger. - Some layouts could be better optimised for small screens. - Limited interactive UI components. - Limited use of interactive data visualisation or maps. - Performance could be affected by large media assets if not optimised.

Growing Home	textual content. - Clear separation between programmes, impact and participation. - Strong potential for reusable UI components. - Clear calls-to-action for user engagement.	- Accessibility could be improved through stronger semantic and interaction practices.
Cultivate London	- Clear categorisation of the organisation's main activities. - Good internal navigation, with dedicated pages for each activity/project. - Service categories are well defined and cover the organisation's full range of activities. - Footer provides access to important resources (GDPR documentation, annual reports). - Testimonials provide social proof and credibility.	Relatively dated visual design and interface. - Deep dropdown submenus may be harder to manage on smaller screens. - Several sections rely heavily on text and simple headings, with insufficient distinction between primary and secondary information. - Service cards could be more visually distinctive. - Lack of a reusable component system. - Content is mostly static, missing features such as an interactive map, project filtering, animated statistics or image galleries. - Mobile layout and content density could be further optimised.
Sutton Community	- Efficient e-commerce system: category-based navigation, per-product pricing, one-click "add to basket." - Modern technical features: account/sign-in system, cookie-consent banner,	- Homepage is quite lengthy, with many blocks of text (especially news articles) repeated in various places. - Large product images may slow down page loading speed. - Repetition of the same blocks makes navigation less efficient and simple. - No visible search bar to quickly find a

Farm	newsletter subscription form. - Mobile-friendly design that can be used on different devices. - Clear menu structure separating shop categories from information pages.	product or page.
Growing Gardens	- Content-rich site architecture with a multi-level menu covering a wide range of programmes. - Functional elements such as a search bar, an authorisation/account area, and an integrated shop. - Statistics section introduces a dynamic element of data and information. - Consistent page structure (repeated use of banners, tiles and a donor/supporter area).	- Deep menus mean numerous clicks are needed to access content from the homepage. - Lack of a single, clearly visible call-to-action (e.g. "donate" or "join") at the centre of the homepage. - Animated counters are likely built on JavaScript, which can affect accessibility. - Homepage contains a higher degree of promotional banners compared to a clear, well-structured information hierarchy.